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February 18, 2026

Search Committee
Finance Area
Cornell SC Johnson College of Business
Cornell University
Ithaca, NY

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the tenure track position in Finance at the rank of Assistant Professor in the Cornell SC Johnson College of Business, with affiliation in the Peter and Stephanie Nolan School of Hotel Administration. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for trust and returns (consistent with the literature) and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly drawn to the Cornell SC Johnson College of Business because of its integrated structure across the Nolan, Johnson, and Dyson schools and its strong commitment to research excellence in finance and applied economics. The Nolan School's focus on real asset markets, hospitality, and industry facing research creates a natural environment for work on heterogeneous returns, portfolio allocation, and asset pricing across sectors. My research on return dispersion and wealth concentration speaks directly to questions about risk allocation, long horizon investment behavior, and the structure of capital markets. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to undergraduate, MBA, and doctoral instruction in finance and to supervise Ph.D. students working at the intersection of macro finance and applied microeconomics.

Cornell's combination of academic rigor, industry access, and cross school collaboration is especially appealing. I am enthusiastic about relocating to Ithaca and engaging fully in the in person academic

community. A tenure track appointment at Cornell would provide the ideal setting to further develop my research agenda in heterogeneous returns, macro finance, and public finance, while contributing to the College's teaching and mentoring mission.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this position because:

1. My research on heterogeneous returns and wealth dynamics aligns closely with core questions in finance regarding risk, asset pricing, and long term capital allocation.
2. I am committed to high quality teaching across undergraduate, MBA, and Ph.D. levels and to mentoring doctoral students.
3. I bring a rigorous quantitative toolkit and a collaborative approach that complements and extends the strengths of the SC Johnson College faculty.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my research and teaching interests align with the goals of the Cornell SC Johnson College of Business.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards